



THE KENYA CONSUMER PRICE INDEX AND INFLATION REPORT

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Overview

Annual consumer price inflation as measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI) was 6.7 per cent in May 2026. This implies that the general price level was 6.7 per cent higher in May 2026 than it was in May 2025. The price increase was primarily driven by a rise in prices of items in the Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages (9.4%); Transport (16.5%), and Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and other fuels (3.4%) over the one-year period. These three divisions together account for over 57 per cent of the total weight across the 13 major expenditure categories.

Consumer Price Index (CPI) is defined as a measure of the weighted aggregate change over time in retail prices paid by consumers for a given basket of goods and services. The CPI measures the cost of purchasing this fixed basket of goods and services, comparing current prices to those of a base period, which for the current CPI is February 2019. Inflation rate is defined as a percentage change of the CPI between two periods. There are different inflation rates that can be computed, such as annual (year-on-year), quarterly (quarter-to-quarter) and monthly (month-on-month) inflation rates. Data used to derive the inflation rates is collected through a monthly survey of retail prices from a statistically representative sample of outlets in urban areas across 50 data collection zones nationwide. The survey is conducted during the second and third weeks of the month.

The Overall CPI and Inflation Trends, May 2025 – May 2026

As presented in Figure 1, the overall index increased from 152.15 in April 2026 to 154.56 in May 2026, resulting in a monthly inflation rate of 1.6 per cent. The year-on-year inflation stood at 6.7 per cent in May 2026 as shown in Figure 2.

Figure 1: Overall CPI, May 2025 – May 2026

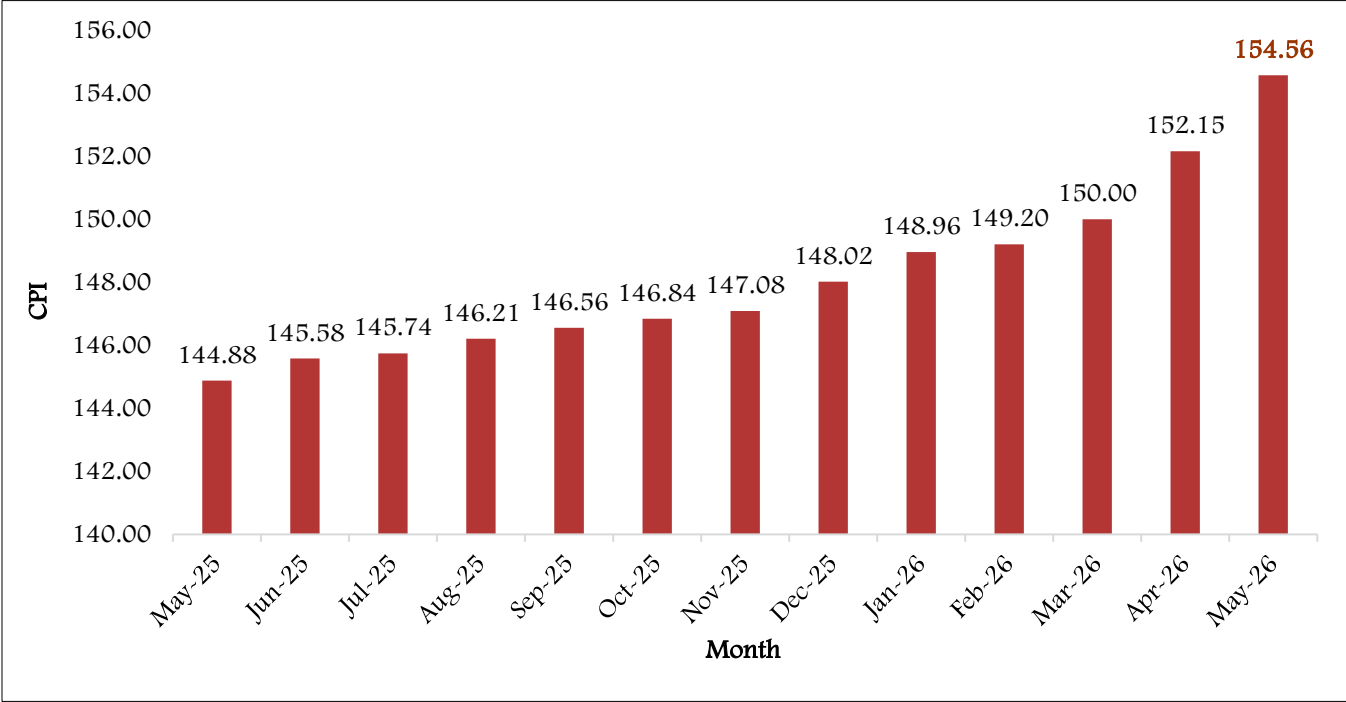


Figure 2: Inflation Trends, May 2025 –May 2026

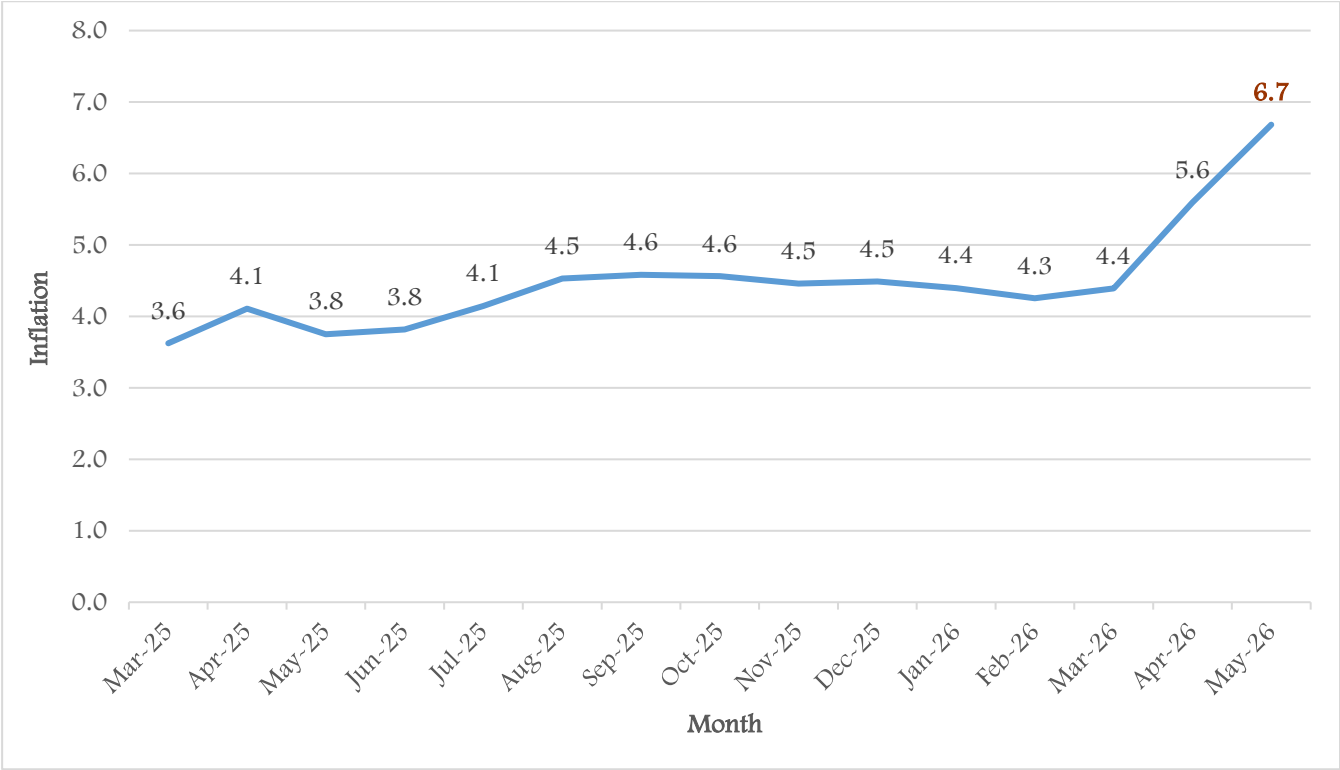


Table 1: One and Twelve-Month Percentage Changes in the Consumer Price Indices

13 COICOP Divisions	Weight %	% Change on last month (May 2026 / April 2026)	% Change on same month of the previous year May 2026 / May 2025)
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	32.9094	1.8	9.4
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	3.3289	0.2	2.5
Clothing and Footwear	2.9914	0.2	2.0
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	14.6124	0.9	3.4
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance	3.7372	0.3	1.9
Health	2.9116	0.2	2.6
Transport	9.6468	6.1	16.5
Information and Communication	7.7840	0.0	0.6
Recreation, Sport and Culture	1.7219	0.1	2.5
Education Services	5.5620	0.0	3.1
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	8.0991	0.2	2.6
Insurance and Financial Services	2.2423	0.0	0.8
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	4.4532	0.3	2.5
Total	100.0000	1.6	6.7

Figure 3: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, April 2026 –May 2026

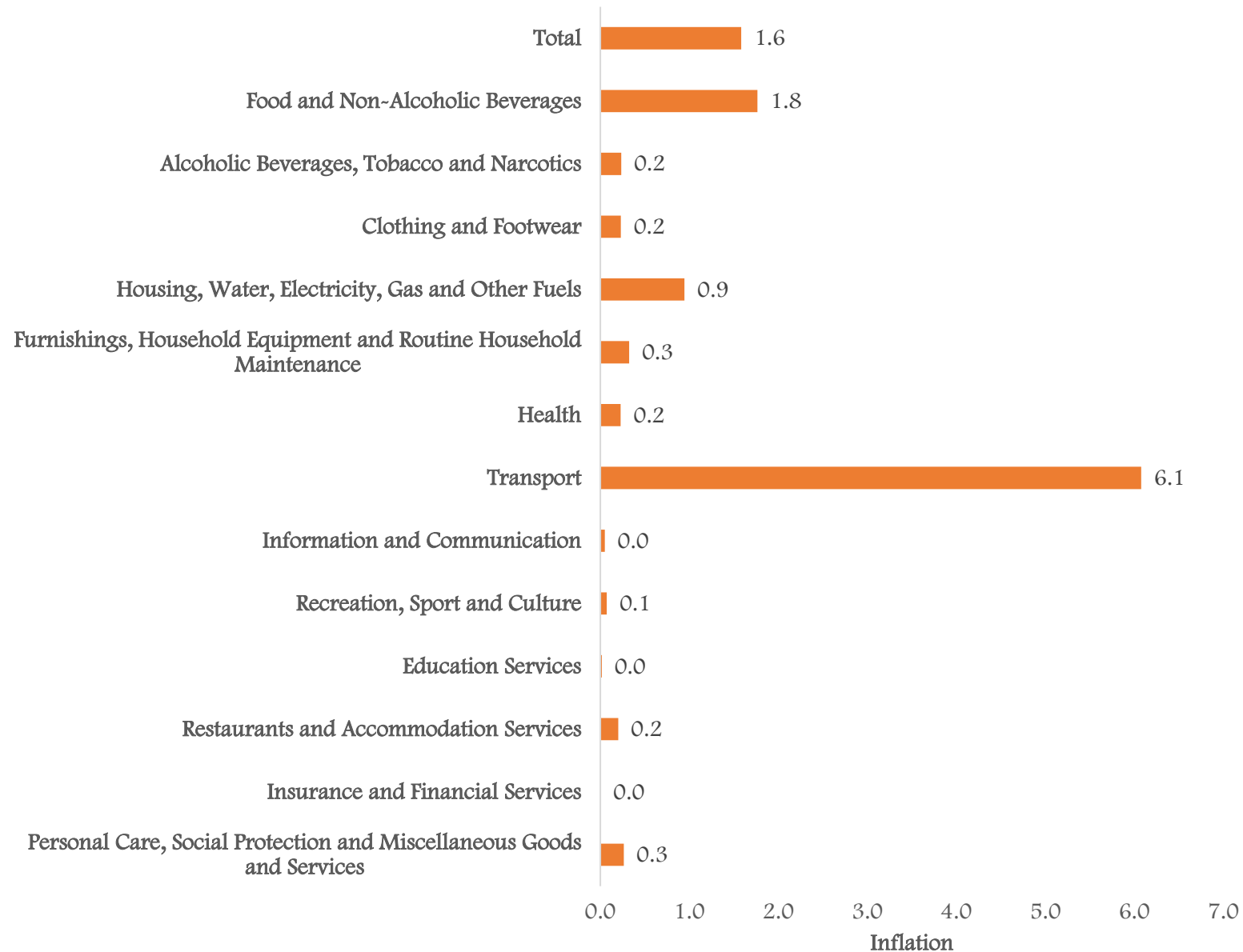


Figure 4: Percentage Changes in CPI Across the 13 Divisions, May 2025 – May 2026

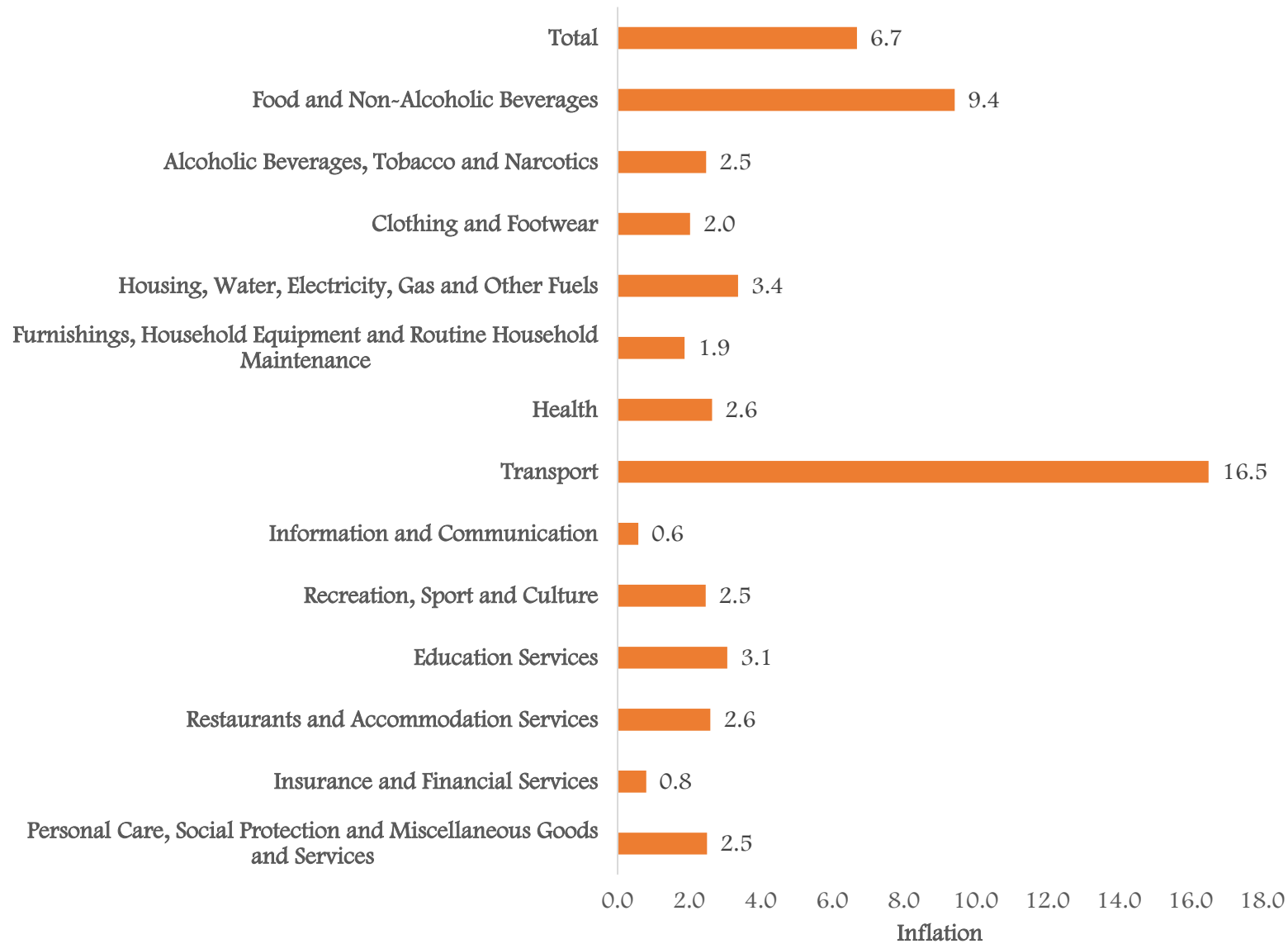
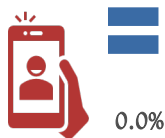
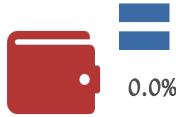
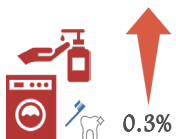


Table 2: Key Drivers of Inflation for each of the 13 Divisions

Monthly		Yearly
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages		
 1.8%	Between April and May 2026, most vegetables recorded notable price increases. Cabbages and spinach increased by 5.0 per cent and 5.2 per cent respectively, while tomatoes registered the highest increase at 11.2 per cent. In contrast, prices of beans and oranges declined by 0.4 per cent and 0.2 per cent respectively.	 9.4% Over the twelve months until May 2026, the Food and Non-alcoholic Beverages division index rose by 9.4%.
Transport		
 6.1%	During the period between April 2026 and May 2026, petrol prices increased by 8.4 per cent, while tuk tuk fares rose by 12.0 per cent. Diesel recorded the highest increase at 18.4 per cent during the reference period.	 16.5% Over the twelve months until May 2026, the index for the Transport division rose by 16.5 per cent.
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels		
 0.9%	Between April and May 2026, Electricity prices for households consuming 50 kWh and 200 kWh declined by 2.4 per cent and 2.2 per cent, respectively, during the reference period, while kerosene/paraffin prices increased by 25.3 per cent.	 3.4% Over the twelve months until May 2026, the general price levels for the division rose by 3.4 per cent.
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics		
 0.2%	Between April and May 2026, prices of beer (lager) and cigarettes increased slightly by 0.2 per cent and 0.1 per cent, respectively, while miraa (khat) recorded a higher increase of 3.0 per cent during the reference period.	 2.5% Over the twelve months until May 2026, the Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics index rose by 2.5%.
Clothing and Footwear		
 0.2%	Prices of girls' dresses, men's shirts, and women's dresses each increased by 0.6 per cent during the reference period.	 2.0% Over the twelve months until May 2026, the prices under Clothing and Footwear division rose by 2.0%.
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance		
 0.3%	Between April and May 2026, prices of laundry soap and detergents increased by 0.5 per cent and 0.9 per cent, respectively. On the other hand, prices of blankets declined by 0.1 per cent during the reference period	 1.9% Over the twelve months until May 2026, the prices under Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household Maintenance division rose by 1.9%.
Health		
 0.2%	Prices of Medicines for cholesterol and Blood pressure, general practitioner consultation services, and delivery charges increased by 0.4, 0.1 and 0.8 per cent, respectively, during the reference period.	 2.6% Over the twelve months until May 2026, the Health division index rose by 2.6%.

Monthly	Yearly
Information and Communication	
 Between April and May 2026, ICT index remained constant 0.0%	 The sector recorded a annual inflation of 0.6%. 0.6%
Recreation, Sport and Culture	
 Prices of religious books increased by 1.3 per cent during the reference period, while prices of school tertiary and preprimary and primary textbooks recorded an increases of 0.2 per cent and 0.1 per cent respectively. 0.1%	 Over the twelve months until May 2026, the Recreation, Sport and Culture division index went up by 2.5%. 2.5%
Education Services	
 Education index remained constant during the period 0.0	 Over the twelve months until May 2026, the index for the Education division increased by 3.1%. 3.1%
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	
 Prices of food purchased from vendors, canteens/kiosks, and hotels and restaurants increased by 0.3, 0.6 and 0.2 per cent, respectively, during the reference period.	 Over the twelve months until May 2026, the index for the Restaurants and Accommodation Services division rose by 2.6%. 2.6%
Insurance and Financial Services	
 Between April and May 2026, insurance costs remained the same 0.0%	 Over the twelve months until May 2026, the prices under Insurance and Financial Services division went up by 0.8%. 0.8%
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services	
 Between April and May 2026, Prices of sanitary towels/tampons, hair dressing services, and toilet paper/tissue paper increased by 0.6, 0.2 and 1.4 per cent, respectively. 0.3%	 Over the twelve months until May 2026, the index for the Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods and Services division increased by 2.5%. 2.5%

Movement of National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Table 3 shows movement of national average retail prices of selected commodities May 2025, April 2026 and May 2026. Between April 2026 and May 2026, the price of cooking oil (salad) rose from KSh 353.77 to KSh 355.79 per litre, while a 2 Kg packet of sifted maize flour increased from KSh 158.06 to KSh 159.12. Cabbage prices recorded an increase, rising from KSh 69.15 to KSh 72.61 per kilogram. Fuel prices also registered significant increases during the period, with petrol prices rising from KSh 197.60 to KSh

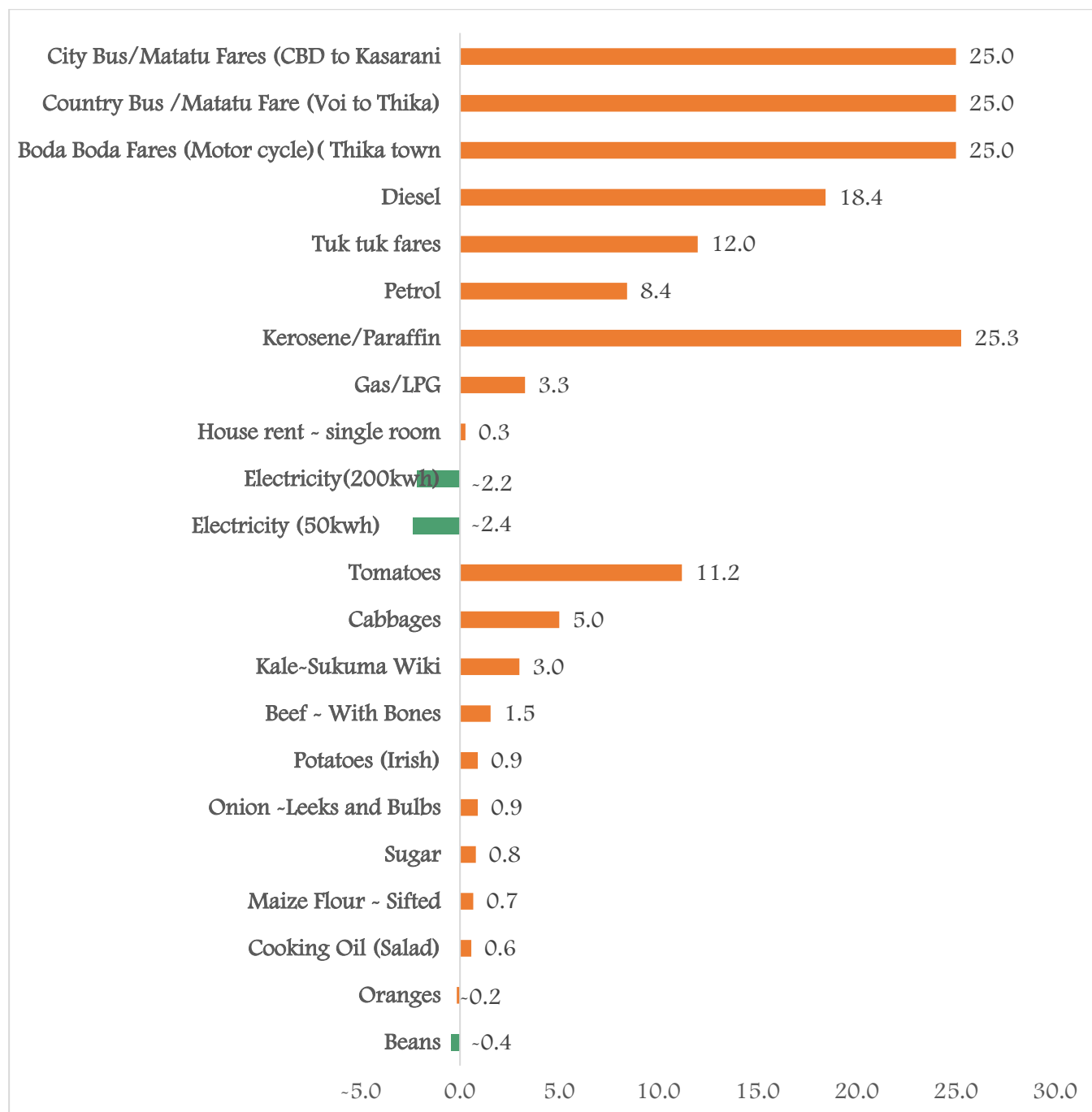
214.25 per litre and diesel increasing from KSh 196.63 to KSh 232.86 per litre. Kerosene/paraffin prices also increased from KSh 152.78 to KSh 191.38 per litre.

In contrast, electricity costs declined between April and May 2026. The average cost of electricity consumption for 50 kilowatts decreased from KSh 1,288.98 to KSh 1,258.57, while the cost for 200 kilowatts declined from KSh 5,656.88 to KSh 5,535.22.

Table 3: National Average Retail Prices of Selected Commodities

Commodity Name	Quantity	Unit of Measure	Average Price May 2025	Average Price April 2026	Average Price May 2026	% Change over last month May 2026/ April 2026	% Change over last year May 2026/ May 2025
Beans	1	Kg	184.81	182.63	181.83	-0.4	-1.6
Oranges	1	Kg	108.15	121.28	121.08	-0.2	12.0
Cooking Oil (Salad)	1	Litre	348.74	353.77	355.79	0.6	2.0
Maize Flour - Sifted	2	Kgs	156.92	158.06	159.12	0.7	1.4
Sugar	1	Kg	174.47	164.35	165.66	0.8	-5.0
Onion -Leeks and Bulbs	1	Kg	105.37	116.37	117.37	0.9	11.4
Potatoes (Irish)	1	Kg	90.35	110.16	111.16	0.9	23.0
Beef - With Bones	1	Kg	685.67	749.65	761.20	1.5	11.0
Kale-Sukuma Wiki	1	Kg	89.53	106.86	110.07	3.0	22.9
Cabbages	1	Kg	52.69	69.15	72.61	5.0	37.8
Spinach	1	Kg	102.15	115.16	121.11	5.2	18.6
Tomatoes	1	Kg	82.88	108.60	120.75	11.2	45.7
Electricity	50	kWh	1,302.35	1,288.98	1,258.57	-2.4	-3.4
Electricity	200	kWh	5,824.08	5,656.88	5,535.22	-2.2	-5.0
House rent - single room	1	Per Month	4,169.57	4,201.41	4,212.89	0.3	1.0
Gas/LPG	13	Kg	3,141.30	3,361.56	3,471.58	3.3	10.5
Kerosene/Paraffin (Nairobi)	1	Litre	148.99	152.78	191.38	25.3	28.5
Petrol (Nairobi)	1	Litre	174.63	197.60	214.25	8.4	22.7
Tuk tuk fares	1	Ticket	93.78	98.87	110.71	12.0	18.1
Diesel (Nairobi)	1	Litre	164.86	196.63	232.86	18.4	41.2
Boda Boda Fares (Motor cycle) - Thika town	1	Ticket	80.00	80.00	100.00	25.0	25.0
Country Bus /Matatu Fare (Voi to Thika)	1	Ticket	1,300.00	1,200.00	1,500.00	25.0	15.4
City Bus/Matatu Fares (CBD to Kasarani)	1	Ticket	80.00	80.00	100.00	25.0	25.0

Figure 5: Percentage Change Over Last Month, April 2026 –May 2026



Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation

Core inflation is a measure that is compiled from non-volatile commodities such as manufactured food items, health services, education services, and ICT. Core inflation stood at 3.2 per cent in May 2026, as presented in Table 4. Non-core inflation was 16.0 per cent during the same period.

Table 4: Core and Non-Core Index and Inflation

Period	Core Index	Core Inflation	Non-Core Index	Non-Core Inflation
May-25	128.97	2.8	209.35	6.0
Jun-25	129.47	3.0	211.24	6.2
Jul-25	129.59	3.1	211.69	7.2
Aug-25	129.57	3.0	213.85	9.2
Sep-25	129.52	2.9	215.78	9.6
Oct-25	129.56	2.7	216.87	9.9
Nov-25	129.66	2.3	217.54	10.1
Dec-25	130.09	2.0	220.84	11.2
Jan-26	130.60	2.2	223.74	10.3
Feb-26	130.72	2.1	224.68	10.1
Mar-26	131.07	2.1	227.82	10.8
Apr-26	132.10	2.8	234.61	13.4
May-26	133.16	3.2	242.75	16.0

Contribution of Core and Non-Core to the Overall Inflation

Contribution of core and non-core inflation to the overall inflation is presented in Table 5. Core inflation contributed 3.8 points, while non-core inflation contributed 2.9 points to the overall inflation in May 2026. Food and non-alcoholic beverages contributed to 2.7 points to the overall inflation during the same period.

Table 5: Core and Non-Core Contributions, May 2026

Broad Categories	Core	Non Core	Total
Food and Non-Alcoholic Beverages	0.8	1.9	2.7
Alcoholic Beverages, Tobacco and Narcotics	0.1	0.0	0.1
Clothing and Footwear	0.2	0.0	0.2
Housing, Water, Electricity, Gas and Other Fuels	0.2	0.4	0.5
Furnishings, Household Equipment and Routine Household	0.3	0.0	0.3
Health	0.2	0.0	0.2
Transport	1.0	0.6	1.6
Information and Communication	0.1	0.0	0.1
Recreation, Sport and Culture	0.1	0.0	0.1
Education Services	0.2	0.0	0.2
Restaurants and Accommodation Services	0.3	0.0	0.3
Insurance and Financial Services	0.1	0.0	0.1
Personal Care, Social Protection and Miscellaneous Goods	0.2	0.0	0.2
Total	3.8	2.9	6.7



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